

Safety

Location: ECTLC

Time: Wednesday: 10:00AM

Facilitator: Glenn Morgan

Audience: Men, Women and Family
Participants

Class Objective

By the end of the class, participants will understand safety as an active recovery discipline within the Rhombus Model, recognize early warning signs of unsafe conditions, identify four practical areas where recovery safety must be built, and connect safety behaviors to housing stability, long-term recovery, and forward movement through the continuum of care.

Opening Frame

"Recovery becomes possible when life becomes safe enough to change."

Safety is not just avoiding danger. Safety is the structure that protects progress.

Within the Rhombus Model, safety is not treated as a side issue. It is part of the operating structure that protects recovery long enough for people to stabilize, prepare, and move forward.

1. Recall

Purpose: Connect safety to lived experience before teaching concepts.

Ask participants:

Before relapse happened in the past, what changed first?

When your life felt most unstable, what was happening around you?

Write responses on the board in four columns:

Physical	Emotional	Social	Environmental
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lack of sleep	anger escalation	conflict with others	losing structure
fatigue	anxiety	isolation	financial stress
substance exposure	feeling overwhelmed	reconnecting with old contacts	skipping meetings

Facilitator summary: Most people do not relapse suddenly. Safety usually breaks down first.

2. Brainstorm

Transition: If recovery requires safety, what actually makes a recovery environment safe?

Ask participants to call out answers and organize them on the board under these categories:

People	Places	Habits	Decisions
accountability partners staff support sober peers	ECTLC campus meetings structured environments Church	sleep routines work participation attending class daily check-ins	avoiding triggers asking for help early following structure telling the truth

Facilitator transition: Safety improves when it becomes intentional instead of accidental.

3. Teach

Teaching Segment A: Safety Is a Recovery Skill

Safety is not something you wait to feel. Safety is something you practice.

Examples inside ECTLC:

- showing up on time
- participating in work therapy
- following expectations
- maintaining routines
- staying accountable

Key statement: Structure protects recovery before motivation does.

In the Rhombus Model, safety is part of the Protect-stage structure that supports stability before a person can prepare for greater responsibility and movement.

Teaching Segment B: Four Practical Areas Where Recovery Safety Must Be Built

Safety is the Protect-stage structure that stabilizes recovery long enough for preparation and forward movement to begin inside the Rhombus continuum of care: Protect, Prepare, Propel.

1. Physical Safety

- staying substance-free
- maintaining sleep
- following facility expectations
- avoiding high-risk locations

Ask: What physical habit protects recovery the most right now?

2. Emotional Safety

Emotional instability often appears before relapse behavior.

- unmanaged anger
- shutting down
- anxiety spikes
- avoiding conversations
- feeling overwhelmed without support

Key teaching line: If emotions become unsafe, decisions usually follow.

3. Relational Safety

Not every familiar relationship supports recovery.

- avoiding enabling relationships
- choosing accountable peers
- respecting boundaries
- rebuilding trust slowly

Key statement: Recovery sometimes requires changing who has access to you.

4. Environmental Safety

Recovery improves when environment supports stability.

- structured schedule
- work therapy participation
- classes and meetings
- staff accountability
- predictable expectations

Key statement: Environment can either support recovery or compete with it.

ECTLC is intentionally designed as a recovery-supporting environment within the Rhombus operating system structure.

Work participation is not just activity, it is a safety mechanism that helps stabilize identity, schedule, responsibility, and accountability.

Teaching Segment C: Safety and Responsibility Work Together

Compassion	Responsibility
Your past affected you	Your next decision belongs to you
Support is available	Participation is required
Change takes time	Structure protects progress

Our approach here holds both sides together at the same time. Safety increases when responsibility increases.

4. Continuum of Care Positioning

Within the Rhombus continuum of care, safety belongs first to **Protect**, because people need stabilization before they can prepare for larger responsibilities or move forward into propulsion.

Protect	Prepare	Propel
create safety, structure, accountability, and immediate stability	build habits, life skills, responsibility, and readiness	move toward housing, employment, long-term recovery, and sustained progress

Facilitator point: Safety is where recovery is protected first, so that growth can be prepared for and forward movement can be sustained.

5. Group Reflection Discussion

Ask participants:

- Which type of safety is hardest for people in recovery to maintain?
- Which type of safety helps recovery the fastest?
- What usually weakens safety first?

- How does stronger safety help someone move from Protect into Prepare?

Allow open discussion. Affirm participation and insight.

6. Recap

Ask: What is one idea from today that changed how you think about safety?

Close with:

"Safety is not restriction. Safety is the structure that makes progress possible."

Safety supports long-term recovery, employment readiness, housing stability, and reduced recidivism by protecting the conditions needed for lasting change.

Rhombus-aligned class-ready lesson plan for ECTL.